BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

When checks happen

The columns show order, not equal periods. There is no fixed number of cycles for these plans. Agree who books each check, when results are reviewed and whom to contact if a check is missed.

Check	Before starting	Early treatment	Repeated treatment	Longer-term review	Pause / completion
Blood counts, kidney and liver	Baseline blood count, kidney and liver profile	Review results before treatment	Blood count, kidney and liver tests before each cycle	Repeat sooner if symptoms or results need it	Follow any unresolved abnormal result
Magnesium, calcium and potassium	Check mineral levels before starting	Repeat periodically during treatment	Keep blood-test and replacement appointments	More checks may be needed if levels fall or diarrhoea develops	Monthly checks for two months after the last antibody dose
Skin, nails, eyes and breathing	Discuss existing skin, eye or lung problems	Start the prescribed skin-care plan; report reactions early	Review skin, nails, diarrhoea and new symptoms	Eye pain, worsening breathing or severe rash needs prompt assessment	Continue care until symptoms and mineral levels settle
Fluorouracil safety and line	Confirm the dihydropyrimidine dehydrogenase (a medicine-processing enzyme) (DPD) test and safe line/pump arrangements	Check mouth, bowel and pump symptoms early	Review line, pump and previous-cycle toxicity	Report chest pain or unexpectedly severe early side effects immediately	Confirm disconnection and ongoing line care
Heart history and new symptoms	Review heart history; electrocardiogram (ECG) if cardiac function is compromised	Report chest pain or new breathlessness immediately	Review new symptoms before further treatment	Further heart tests when clinically indicated	Follow any heart problem; no routine serial echo timetable
Nerve symptoms	Record any numbness or tingling before treatment	Cold sensitivity can occur early	Formal neuropathy assessment every two cycles	Report persistent symptoms or difficulty with daily tasks before the next dose	Follow symptoms after oxaliplatin stops
Cancer response and treatment choices	Record baseline disease and agree review plan	Bring forward review if symptoms worsen	Scans and other tests follow your consultant's treatment plan	Discuss benefit, side effects and whether the goal has changed	Agree continuation, a break, another treatment or supportive care

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00692 v2 · official regimen · EMA: Erbitux product information and patient leaflet

Tests in your plan

Carcinoembryonic antigen (CEA) — colorectal plans

If part of your plan

WHEN

For a colorectal cancer plan, if your team uses CEA; your team sets the interval.

A marker trend interpreted alongside symptoms, examination and scans.

Record the baseline, latest result and next date. A marker change alone does not establish progression.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Weekly cetuximab + FOLFOX-4: treatment and checks

Advanced / metastatic colorectal cancer

Cetuximab on Day 1 and Day 8. FOLFOX4 starts on Day 1: oxaliplatin, folinic acid and fluorouracil bolus, followed by a 22-hour fluorouracil infusion. Day 2 brings another fluorouracil bolus and a second 22-hour infusion; finish around Day 3. Your team confirms the full Day 2 prescription. Repeat every 14 days while beneficial and tolerable.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Early treatment	Repeated treatment	Longer-term review	Pause / completion
Blood counts, kidney and liver NCCP 00692	Baseline blood count, kidney and liver profile	Review results before treatment	Blood count, kidney and liver tests before each cycle	Repeat sooner if symptoms or results need it	Follow any unresolved abnormal result
Magnesium, calcium and potassium NCCP 00692	Check mineral levels before starting	Repeat periodically during treatment	Keep blood-test and replacement appointments	More checks may be needed if levels fall or diarrhoea develops	Monthly checks for two months after the last antibody dose

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Skin, nails, eyes and breathing NCCP 00692	Discuss existing skin, eye or lung problems	Start the prescribed skin-care plan; report reactions early	Review skin, nails, diarrhoea and new symptoms	Eye pain, worsening breathing or severe rash needs prompt assessment	Continue care until symptoms and mineral levels settle
Fluorouracil safety and line NCCP 00692	Confirm the DPD test and safe line/ pump arrangements	Check mouth, bowel and pump symptoms early	Review line, pump and previous-cycle toxicity	Report chest pain or unexpectedly severe early side effects immediately	Confirm disconnection and ongoing line care
Heart history and new symptoms NCCP 00692	Review heart history; ECG if cardiac function is compromised	Report chest pain or new breathlessness immediately	Review new symptoms before further treatment	Further heart tests when clinically indicated	Follow any heart problem; no routine serial echo timetable
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Cancer response and treatment choices NCCP 00692	Record baseline disease and agree review plan	Bring forward review if symptoms worsen	Scans and other tests follow your consultant's treatment plan	Discuss benefit, side effects and whether the goal has changed	Agree continuation, a break, another treatment or supportive care

What each check is for

1

A 14-day reference cycle

Clinic → home → review

The aim is to control advanced bowel cancer and symptoms. The team reviews how well treatment is working and whether side effects remain acceptable; there is no single fixed number of cycles for everyone.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00692

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-05 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.36